



TV Tuners

Internal TV Tuner Cards

Compro VideoMate TV Gold Plus

Specs: MPEG 1/2 Capture supported, 720 x 576 maximum resolution supported and Nicam Stereo

Our Verdict: Compro's Videomate TV Gold Plus is an excellent TV tuner card that is characterised by good quality signal reception. The card can tune to most channels perfectly without any human intervention. The software bun-

dled is excellent, and provides an easy interface for most people.

Runner-up:

Mercury TV Tuner Card



Wireless Devices

802.11g Access Points

Buffalo WBR2-G54

Specs: 4 LAN ports, one external antenna port, WEP and WPA encryption, firewall and wireless bridging offered

Our Verdict: This 802.11g access point from Buffalo fared well in all the tests we put it through. It has a good data transfer rate and offers a reasonably good feature

set for setting up a personal access point.

Runner-up:

D-link DWL-2000AP+



Ring Out The Old, Ring In The New

These products were the highlight of 2004 from a technology point of view. However, these weren't the only products that made year 2004 momentous—there could have been many more of them to complete the list.

Technology is moving so fast it's becoming increasingly tough to keep pace. Even as we compiled this list of the best tested products of 2004, new technologies are evolving, and some of them such as SLi from nVidia, new 64-bit processors from AMD, and desktop motherboards from Aopen for the Pentium M processor will be in the market about the same time the magazine hit the stands, or in early-2005.

So, before we drop the curtains on the Zero-One Awards 2004, a look at imminent technologies that could change the computing landscape.

SLi is the next revolution in the graphics arena. Way back in the late '90s, 3DFX did the same thing with their Voodoo series, and now, after nVidia has brought over 3DFX, they are getting their act together with powerful cards.

SLi will allow you to plug in two graphics cards on the same motherboard. According to the various Web sites that had benchmarked SLi-based

solutions, you can expect a 60 to 70 per cent boost in frame rate at high resolutions. Expect SLi to hit India any time around January 2005.

Both Intel and AMD have decided to launch dual core processors by mid-2005. AMD might make it earlier than will Intel. But the point is not who makes it first—rather, the advantages of having two physical processing cores on a single chip.

The possibilities are endless. These processor breeds can do wonders if all goes as expected.

AOpen and several other manufacturers recently launched desktop boards for the Pentium M processor. The Pentium M series is well-known for the performance it offers, and for low power consumption. Due to the low power consumption, the chips require less cooling, and that, in turn, results in less noise from the PC box.

The Pentium M line of processor is so good that there are rumours of Intel using them for their upcoming dual-core processor. Because of their inherent advantages, we might see them being used in media centre PCs and small form factor PCs.

So—keep an eye out for a whole lot of new technologies in 2005! Rest assured, Digit would feature each of them in its exhaustive tests. ☐

